or Śiva. The Hindu, while he creates these symbols or images of his God in order to have a concentrated idea of any one of His attributes or name or form *(Nāma,* or *Rūpa)* to assist him in his psychological development toward divine realization, is not establishing any idol of the Supreme Being called God, or Īshvara.

The Hindus also believe that *Nirguna,* or the attributeless Divine Being takes a human form from time to time. When the laws of God are forsaken or downtrodden by human beings, He comes to the earth, lives, moves and has His being among men in this empirical and historical world. By His life on this earth He reveals the ways of God to man. This is technically called the doctrine of the *Divine Avatāra,* or the descent of the Divine in human form. To the present time in the history of Hinduism, ten such *Avatāras* have been recognized. The names of Rama, Krishna, and Buddha are among the most famous. According to traditional belief, the last *Avatāra* is still to come before this present cycle of creation is to be dissolved. The idea of this doctrine is that man by himself cannot be expected to rise to the Divine level, unless he is helped by the Divine in the ascent from the human to the Divine. All religions, in some form or other, believe in the necessity of God's *Avatāra,* or His incarnation in a concrete historical manifestation. Hinduism does not say that any particular prophet is the only son of God; rather, it believes that there can be many sons of God at various times.

THE LAW OF DHARMA

The next belief of the Hindus concerns the moral nature and structure of the universe. The universe is moral because there is a God in it, or one might say that the universe itself is divine. The world of inorganic and organic nature is not just an evolution of an unconscious material power or force creating and expressing itself in a world of greater complexity and heterogeneity by its own unconscious dialectic. It is a world of divine and spiritual immanence with the fullest reality of moral values and forces flowing from *Śakti,* or the power of God. Corresponding to the laws of nature, there are ethical laws in cosmos pertaining to moral living called the Laws of *Ṛta,* or the *Dharma.* The immanence of God is a guarantee for it. What is meant in Hinduism by moral structure of the universe is that no purely naturalistic or merely humanistic interpretation of the universe is going to justify the ultimate reality of our moral values. Without this ultimate justification the world of human beings with all its culture and civilization and its rich complexity and novelty of the numerous mental and moral evo-